

Environment Plan

Prelude

The policy of HCL is to protect and preserve the natural environment and is conscious of upholding highest standards for environment protection while conducting the business. HCL is committed to meet the environment norms set by Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)/ Ministry of Environment & Forest (MOEF). HCL complies with applicable environmental and public safety laws and regulations and develop and implement a comprehensive program to ensure compliance.

With the growing environmental awareness in India and stringent and statutory regulations, HCL obtains all statutory clearances whenever there is any change in production or technology.

We conduct all of our activities in such a manner as to protect the physical environment, our employees, and the general public. We manage and work at all our mines & plants under the principle that any harm to employees or property is preventable. We are both responsible and responsive in matters relating to environmental protection, health and safety.

Environment Policy

In recognition of the interests of the society in securing sustainable industrial growth, compatible with a wholesome environment, HCL affirms that it assigns high importance to promotion and maintenance of a pollution-free environment in all its activities.

Objectives

- To use non-polluting and environment-friendly technology.
- To monitor regularly air, water, land, noise and other environmental parameters.
- To constantly improve upon the standards of pollution control and provide a leadership in environment management.
- To develop employee's awareness on environmental responsibilities and encourage adherence to sound environmental practices.
- To work closely with government and local authorities to prevent or minimize adverse consequences of the industrial activities on the environment.
- To comply with all applicable laws governing environment protection through appropriate mechanisms.
- To actively participate in social, welfare and environmental development activities of the locality around its units.
- To achieve harmony and peace amongst the employees and the local villagers for heading fast towards "sustainable development.
- Meaningful use of forest lands within the lease areas

Work Environment: Ventilation

- A ventilation Department manned by experienced and competent staff is a part of the mine organization. This department undertakes daily monitoring and monthly audit of the ventilation system in the mines and takes necessary steps for improving ventilation in the mine.
- For improving environment in the plant area, particularly close to crusher areas in concentrator plant, flash furnace & converter area of smelter plant, arrangements have been designed to minimal generation and immediate removal of dust & gases to improve ambient air quality at the working places. It is the strategy of HCL that sources of fugitive dust and fumes shall be trapped by water sprinkling, fume, and dust extraction systems.

Noise

- Noise level survey is being conducted regularly as routine and result shown on a noise level plan depicting the location and appropriate details of the noise sources and noise level.
- Use of protecting devices, namely ear muff/plugs, close to the source of high noise source level is enforced. As a long-term measure, equipment having noise level shall be modified. Resonance free enclosure, vibration isolators etc. shall be provided.

Lighting

To achieve high productivity adequate lighting & illumination is a must both in underground and above ground. For this, white washing of all shaft insets, haulage is done with adequate general lighting arrangement are provided during working hours. Adequate lighting arrangement is also being done at surface loading, unloading points in mine. Besides adequate lighting is also being done at all working areas including crushing plants, tail disposal areas etc.

Survey of illumination in the mines & plant is being done regularly by the Internal Safety Organization.

Environment Audit:

- Environment audit at all the four units of HCL to be carried by independent agency to ensure compliance and develop more effective methods for environmental, health and safety protection.
- Establish accountability for all employees to exert leadership and commitment to continual improvement in environmental, health and safety awareness .
- To establish the effectiveness, it is proposed that the corporate frameworks will be aligned with the International Council on Mining and Metals (ICMM) principles of sustainable development and with ISO 14001.

Waste Management

Waste management Initiative envisaged during the plan are:

- Sale of granulated slag generated at ICC, Waste rock dump of mines and ore tailings also being done, Recent study/trend has indicated that granulated slag find use in shipping /engineering & cement industries; waste rock is being widely used in road construction.
- Study has been undertaken and trial plantation has been done for possible re-vegetation over tailing dumps to arrest dust and mud slide and regular turfing is also being done

Afforestation

HCL has adopted afforestation and protection of tree cover as a matter of its culture. Saplings of perennial trees are planted along road sides as well as in open areas and on waste lands in around the townships. HCL is regularly planting sapling in waste dumps after covering top soil.

Going forward, HCL intends that afforestation on a planned pattern in consultation with Divisional Forest Officer (Social forestry) of concerned areas with the objectives such as increasing the density around the project & township, stabilization of degraded lands & waste dumps for preventing soil erosion, rehabilitated of mined out areas, improving the condition of the catchment areas and stream courses and aesthetic look of the township areas. Company plans to identify cash crop for plantation like bamboos etc.

Cutting of trees in connection with construction and other industrial activities is kept to the bare necessity, and in this case adequate compensatory plantation is undertaken.